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TOOL HOLDER

Abstract

A tool holder for holding a tool includes a body and a mount. The body includes an interior region configured to receive the tool, wherein the tool defines a primary axis. The mount includes an angled portion, wherein the mount is coupled to the body, wherein the mount is configured to be secured to an object, and wherein the object defines a primary axis. The mount maintains the body in an orientation such that when the body receives the tool and mount is secured to the object, the primary axis of the tool and the primary axis of the object form an oblique angle.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/428,733, filed on Jan. 31, 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/571,258, filed on Jan. 7, 2022, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,904,453, patented on Feb. 20, 2024, which claims the benefit of U.S. application Ser. No. 29/811,911, filed on Oct. 18, 2021, and U.S. Appl. 63/257,490, filed on Oct. 19, 2021, the entireties of which are incorporated by reference, herein.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Generally, this application relates to a device for holding tools, such as hand-held tools.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

[0003] FIG. 1A is a perspective view of a first configuration of a tool holder.

[0004] FIG. 1B is a perspective view of the first configuration of tool holder holding a drill.

[0005] FIG. 1C is an elevation view of a first configuration of tool holder holding a drill and attached to a portion of a portion of an object.

[0006] FIG. 2A is a perspective view of a second configuration of a tool holder.

[0007] FIG. 2B is a perspective view of the second configuration of tool holder holding a drill.

[0008] FIG. 2C is an elevation view of a second configuration of tool holder holding a drill and attached to a portion of an object.

[0009] FIG. 3A is a perspective view of a third configuration of a tool holder.

[0010] FIG. 3B is a perspective view of the third configuration of tool holder holding a drill.

[0011] FIG. 3C is an elevation view of a third configuration of tool holder holding a drill and attached to a portion of an object.

[0012] FIG. 4 is an exploded view of the first configuration of tool holder.

[0013] FIGS. 5A and 5B are top and bottom perspective views of a body of tool holder.

[0014] FIGS. 6A and 6B are top and bottom perspective views of a mount of tool holder.

[0015] FIGS. 7A and 7B are top and bottom perspective views of a clip of tool holder.

[0016] FIGS. 8A and 8B are top and bottom perspective views of an angled portion of tool holder.

[0017] FIG. 8C is an elevation view of angled portion being mounted to a portion of an object.

[0018] FIGS. 9A and 9B are top and bottom perspective views of a magnet assembly of tool holder.

[0019] FIG. 9C is an exploded view of the magnet assembly.

[0020] FIG. 10A is a front-side elevation view the first configuration of tool holder.

[0021] FIG. 10B is a rear-side elevation view the first configuration of tool holder.

[0022] FIG. 10C is a left-side elevation view the first configuration of tool holder.

[0023] FIG. 10D is a right-side elevation view the first configuration of tool holder.

[0024] FIG. 10E is a top plan view the first configuration of tool holder.

[0025] FIG. 10F is a bottom plan view the first configuration of tool holder.

[0026] FIG. 11 is a perspective view of a fourth configuration of tool holder.

[0027] FIG. 12 is a perspective view of a fifth configuration of a tool holder.

[0028] FIGS. 13A, 13B, 13C, and 13D shows a sequence illustrating how angled portion connects

and disconnects to/from body.

[0029] FIG. 14A is a perspective view of tool holder with a triggering-prevention portion.

[0030] FIG. 14B is a rear-side elevation view of tool holder with a triggering-prevention portion.

[0031] FIG. 15 is an elevation view of tool holder with a triggering-prevention portion, where tool holder is shown holding a drill.

[0032] The foregoing summary, as well as the following detailed description of certain techniques of the present application, will be better understood when read in conjunction with the appended drawings. For the purposes of illustration, certain techniques are shown in the drawings. It should be understood, however, that the claims are not limited to the arrangements and instrumentality shown in the attached drawings. Furthermore, the appearance shown in the drawings is one of many ornamental appearances that can be employed to achieve the stated functions of the system.

SUMMARY

[0033] According to embodiments, a tool holder for holding a tool includes a body and a mount. The body includes an interior region configured to receive the tool, wherein the tool defines a primary axis. The mount includes an angled portion, wherein the mount is coupled to the body, wherein the mount is configured to be secured to an object, and wherein the object defines a primary axis. The mount maintains the body in an orientation such that when the body receives the tool and mount is secured to the object, the primary axis of the tool and the primary axis of the object form an oblique angle. The mount may include at least one clip configured to removably engage the object to secure the mount to the object. Or the mount may not include a clip. If the clip is included, the at least one clip and the angled portion may be non-destructively separable. The mount may be removably coupled to the body and is further configured to be removably coupled in a plurality of positions with respect to the body. The mount may include at least one through-hole configured to receive a fastener to secure the mount to the object. The tool holder may include a triggering-prevention portion coupled to the body, wherein the triggering-prevention portion is configured to prevent a trigger of a tool from being engaged when the tool is held by the tool holder. The triggering-prevention portion may be removably coupled to the body.

[0034] According to embodiments, a tool holder includes a body and a mount. The body includes an interior region configured to receive the tool. The mount is configured to be secured to an object. The mount is further configured to be removably coupled to the body and be selectively positioned in a plurality of positions with respect to the body. The mount may include an angled portion, wherein the object defines a primary axis, and wherein the mount maintains the body in an orientation such that when the body receives the tool and mount is secured to the object, the primary axis of the tool and the primary axis of the object form an oblique angle. The body may include a top face, a right-side face, and a left-side face, wherein the mount is configured to be removably coupled to each of the top face, the right-side face, and the left-side face of the body. The body may include a plurality of sets of receiving features, wherein each set of receiving features is configured to couple the body to the mount, wherein the mount includes two runners, and wherein the receiving features include two rails that respectively receive the two runners. Each set of receiving features may include a stopping portion to stop the travel of the mount when it is received by the set of receiving features. Each set of receiving features may include an aperture, wherein the mount includes a spring arm and a spring arm head, and wherein the aperture is configured to receive the spring arm head, such that the mount securely couples to the body. The aperture may be configured to receive a portion of a human finger such that a user can force the spring arm head out of the aperture to allow the mount to be removed from the body. The tool holder may further include a triggering-prevention portion coupled to the body, wherein the trigger prevention portion is configured to prevent a trigger of a tool from being engaged when the tool is held by the tool holder. The trigger prevention portion may be removably coupled to the body. The tool holder may further include an accessory configured to be removably coupled to the body and be selectively positioned in the plurality of positions with respect to the body. The accessory may

include a magnet assembly. The body may include a bit-size guide including a plurality of apertures corresponding to different sized drill bits, wherein the bit-size guide is configured to indicate to a user the size of a given drill bit

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0035] FIGS. 1A, 2A, and 3A are perspective views of three configurations (first, second, and third) of a tool holder **100**. As will be further described, there may be more configurations of tool holder **100**. FIGS. 1B, 2B, and 3B are perspective views of the three configurations (first, second, and third, respectively) of tool holder **100** holding a cordless drill **10**. Instead of drill **10**, any device or item (tool) that could be retained in tool holder **100** is contemplated. Other examples of a tool include power tools (handheld, cordless, corded, etc.) or conventional tools (hammers, wrenches, painting implements, etc.). The shape of tool holder **100** may be adapted to more particularly accommodate different types of tools **10**, as is apparent. FIGS. 1C, 2C, and 3C are perspective views of the three configurations (first, second, and third, respectively) of tool holder **100** mounted to a portion of an object **20** and holding drill **10**, according to certain embodiments. In FIGS. 1C and 2C, object **20** is horizontally arranged, like a shelf. In FIG. 3C, object **20** is vertically arranged, like a sidewall. Other types of objects **20** may be located on a user's person, such as a belt or harness. FIGS. 1C, 2C, and 3C are non-limiting examples. Each configuration of tool holder **100** can be mounted to a vertically-arranged, horizontally-arranged, obliquely-arranged, cylindrical, square, or other shaped or arranged object **20**. Also depicted in these figures are different bits **30** that are retained by magnet assembly **170**.

[0036] FIGS. 1C and 2C further show an angle α . As will be understood, Drill **10** defines a primary axis, being the center axis of the chuck and bit of the handheld cordless drill. In the example of drill **10** as shown, the primary axis aligns with the primary axis defined by an interior region of body **150**. Object **20** defines a plane. As shown in FIGS. 1C and 2C, the primary axis of drill **10** (or body **150**) and plane of object **20** form an oblique angle alpha α . This angle α may provide an advantage of keeping drill **10** more stably retained in tool holder **100**, especially when tool holder **100** is secured to a horizontally-arranged object **20**. Because of the oblique angle α , drill **10** may be less likely to fall out of tool holder **100** due to inadvertent contact or vibrations. As shown, α is 15 degrees. Generally, α could be in the range of 5 to 45 degrees, although this range is not limiting. For example, α could be as large as 90 degrees. Embodiments herein show α as being only one value, but it may be possible for α to vary across at least some of this range.

[0037] FIG. 4 is an exploded view of the first configuration of tool holder **100**. Each configuration of tool holder **100** described and depicted herein may be formed from two or more components shown in FIG. 4. Tool holder **100** is understood to describe one or more of these or other configurations. Tool holder **100** may include mount **101**, body **150**, and magnet assembly **170**. Mount **101** may further include clip **110** and/or angled portion **130**. In FIGS. 1A, 1B, and 1C, mount **101** includes clip **110** and angled portion **130**. In FIGS. 2A, 2B, and 2C, mount **101** includes angled portion **130**, but not clip **110**. In FIGS. 3A, 3B, and 3C, mount **101** includes clip **110**, but not angled portion **130**. In this third configuration of tool holder **100**, clip **110** is directly attached body **150**. As depicted and further described, clip **110** does not include features shown in angled portion **130** or magnet assembly **170** that allow clip **110** to couple directly with body **150**. Still, clip **110** may include all or some of such features or other features that allow direct coupling with body **150**.

[0038] Two or more components of tool holder **100** may optionally be integrated or formed as one piece, such that separating them would require additional effort or potentially destroy one or both of the individual components. For example, if mount **101** includes clip **110** and angled portion **130**, these components may be formed as one piece or otherwise integrated. If they are integrated using an epoxy or fastener(s), additional effort may be required to separate them. On the other hand, in certain embodiments of clip **110** and angled portion **130**, the components may be selectively and non-destructively disengageable (e.g., through a clip, button, lever, or the like integrated in one or

both of the components), such that they are not integrated. In other embodiments, a given component of tool holder **100**, such as body **150**, may be separable into two or more pieces. As will further be explained, mount **101** may be removably coupled to body **150**, in which case, mount **101** and body **150** are not integrated. Mount **101** may be removably coupled to body **150** such that it can be selectively positioned in different ones of a plurality of positions with respect to body **150**. [0039] One or more components of tool holder **100** may be formed with a material such as glass-filled nylon and/or propylene. Such a material may have a relatively high resistance to impacts and may feel more “solid” and less tinny. The components may further include a second material, such as an overmold. Examples of a second material include thermoplastic urethane (TPU) or thermoplastic rubber (TPR). The component(s) of tool holder **100** may be formed by injection molding, including optionally one or more overmolding steps.

[0040] FIGS. 5A and 5B are perspective views of body **150**, which receives drill **10**. Body **150** includes a tubular portion **159** (shown as cylindrical) and a tapered or frustoconical portion **151**, together forming an interior region. Frustoconical portion **151** has a plurality of contours **152** (three as shown), which form empty areas in frustoconical portion **151**. Tubular portion **159** may include contours **161** and **162**. Together, contours **161** and **162** form an opening into the interior region of body **150**. Contour **161** defines a portion of the opening that receives the body of drill **10**. Contour **162** defines a portion of the opening that receives the handle of drill **10**. An overmolded portion may be located around some or all of contour **162**. This portion may provide cushion or protection from undue impacts or scratching between body **150** and drill **10** (e.g., handle of drill **10**).

[0041] Body **150** further includes a plate **158** extending outwardly (e.g., radially) from tubular portion **159**. Plate **158** (or another part of tool holder **100**) further defines a set of circular apertures that can serve as a gauge **160** to determine a size of a drill bit or other hardware, such as a screw, bolt or nail. Each aperture can be labeled with a size ($\frac{1}{8}$, $\frac{5}{16}$, etc.) that indicates to the user the diameter of a bit shaft. Plate **158** has areas on the front or rear that can have letters or images, such as a product trademark (e.g., DRILL DOCK™) or logo, instructions, or designation of origin like “Made in the USA” along with a flag (e.g., “Stars and Stripes” or “Old Glory”). Such information may be integral with plate **150** (recessed, embossed, or printed), on a label, or on an overmolded portion (e.g., a second material having a different composition and/or color from the substrate material of plate **158** that is molded or otherwise attached to the substrate material). The overmolded portion can cover other areas of body **150**.

[0042] Body **150** further includes one or more sets of rails. As shown, body includes three sets of rails. The first set includes rails **153a** and **154a**. The second set includes rails **153b** and **154b**. The third set includes rails **153c** and **154c**. The sets of rails may be substantially identical but located at different parts of body **150**. As shown, the first set of rails is on the upper side of body **150**, the second set of rails is on the left side of body **150**, and the third set of rails is on the right side of body **150**. As used herein, rail **153** refers to any one of rails **153a**, **153b**, or **153c**. Rail **154** refers to any corresponding one of rails **154a**, **154b**, or **154c**. Rails **153** and **154** receive clip **110**, angled portion **130**, or magnet assembly **170**. The three sets of rails **153**, **154** allow clip **110**, angled portion **130**, or magnet assembly **170** to be positioned at different locations with respect to body **150**.

[0043] Each set of rails **153**, **154** is associated with a respective aperture **157** (**157a**, **157b**, and **157c**) in body **150**. Each set of rails **153**, **154** is further associated with a first stop **155** (**155a**, **155b**, and **155c**) and a second stop **156** (**156a**, **156b**, and **156c**). Aperture **157** and/or stops **155**, **156** facilitate the ability to couple mount **101** or magnet assembly **170** with body **150**.

[0044] The region around the underside of aperture **157** (i.e., the side of aperture **157** within the hollow interior region of body **150**) forms an arch, which is sized to receive a human finger (e.g., a thumb). The arch includes a tapered region such that the size of the aperture decreases between the underside of aperture **157** and the outer side of aperture **157**. The tapered region is curved to match the contour of a human fingertip. The arch is sized to match a typical human finger (e.g., thumb),

such that a user can easily feel and find the aperture **157** to disengage the spring arm head **136** from body **150**, as will be further described. The maximum width of the arch may match a typical width of a human finger (e.g., 16-20 mm).

[0045] FIGS. **6A** and **6B** are top and bottom perspective views of mount **101** when it includes clip **110** and angled portion **130**. As shown, clip **110** and angled portion **130** are separate pieces, which are coupled together. They may be removably coupled so they can be non-destructively separated. Or clip **110** and angled portion **130** may be permanently coupled such that separation would likely result in damage. In some instances, tool holder **100** includes an additional angled portion **130** and/or additional clip **110** so a user can have more than one type of mount **101** with a purchased tool holder **100**.

[0046] FIGS. **7A** and **7B** are top and bottom perspective views of clip **110**, which is shown to include base **111** defining an aperture **112**. Clip **110** further includes two gripping portions **115**. Clip **110** also includes two spring arms **120**, each having a plurality of ridges **121**. Spring arm **120** has a spoon shape, including three sections—a support **122** coupled to base **111**, an arced portion **123** extending from support **122**, and an elongated portion **124** extending outwardly from arced portion **123** at an angle towards base **111**. Gripping portion **115** (e.g., an overmolded material such as TPU or TPR) is positioned on the underside of spring arm **120**.

[0047] As shown in FIGS. **1C** and **3C**, clip **110** clips to object **20**. Before clipping, elongated portion **124** and base **111** define a minimum separation distance, which can be less than a thickness of object **20**. When clip **110** is inserted on object **20**, elongated portion **124** is forced away from base **111**, thereby compressing spring arm **120**. Then, base **111** and spring arm **125** exert forces against object **20** tending to keep clip **110** securely positioned on object **20**. Furthermore, gripping portion **115** is forced against object **20**, further tending to stabilize the position of clip **110** on object **20**. When clip **110** is removed from object **20**, spring arm **120** returns to its original position.

[0048] Support **122** is shown as having a width that tapers between base **111** and arced portion **123**. This tapering may provide improved strength and durability of clip **110**, such that spring arm **120** is less likely to inadvertently detach or break off from base **111**. Arced portion **123** acts as a spring by compressing/decompressing as elongated portion **124** is moved towards/away base **111**. The arc of arced portion **123** may be defined by a radius, such as 85 degrees.

[0049] Ridges **121** on the upper surface of spring arm **120** are shown to substantially transverse the length of spring arm **120**. Each ridge **121** (three shown) provides a degree of rigidity and strength to spring arm **120** to increase the spring constant and prevent damage to clip **110** from potential overextension of spring arm **120**. As shown, a ridge **121** is positioned along each lateral side of spring arm **120**, and another ridge **121** is positioned in between the lateral ridges **121**.

[0050] Aperture **112** accepts a feature on angled portion **130** to attach angled portion **130** with clip **110**. Clip **110** also includes feature **114**, which engages with a recess in angled portion **130** to attach clip **110** to angled portion **130**.

[0051] FIGS. **8A** and **8B** are top and bottom perspective views of angled portion **130**. FIG. **8C** is an elevation view of angled portion **130** being mounted to object **20**. Angled portion **130** includes angled body **137**, first runner **131**, second runner **132**, guides **133**, mounting holes **134**, spring arm **135**, and spring arm head **136**. Angled body **137** defines a lower contour and upper contour that form an angle. This angle determines at least in part the angle at which drill **10** is oriented with respect to object **20**. As shown in FIGS. **1C** and **2C**, angle α is 15 degrees, which corresponds to the angle defined by angled body **137**. Generally, the angle defined by body could be between 5 and 45 degrees, although this range useful but non-limiting. As shown, this angle does not change, but angled portion **130** could be adjustable to provide for a range of angles. Furthermore, angled portion **130** could be mounted to body **150** and/or clip **110** in different ways to provide for different angles between drill **10** and object **20**.

[0052] Runners **131**, **132** extend outwardly from angled body **137**. Runners **131**, **132** engage with rails **154**, **153**, respectively. Specifically, rails **153**, **154** form tracks through which runners **131**, **132**

securely travel. This allows angled portion **130** to slide into one of three different locations on body **150**, using either first set of rails **153a**, **154a**, second set of rails **153b**, **154b**, or third set of rails **153c**, **154c**. When angled portion **130** slides into body **150** using the system of runners **131**, **132** and rails **153**, **154**, the forward motion of angled portion **130** is limited. As angled portion **130** slides along, angled body **137** will encounter stops **155**, **156**, thereby preventing additional forward motion. Angled portion **130** further includes mounting guides **133** and mounting holes **134**. As shown in FIG. **8C**, mounting guides **133** allow for accurate positioning of angled portion **130** on object **20**. Mounting holes **134** receive fasteners that attach angled portion **130** to object **20**. Angled portion **130** further includes spring arm **135** and spring arm head **136**. Spring arm **135** and spring arm head **136** interact with aperture **157**, as depicted in FIGS. **13A-13D** and will be described below.

[0053] FIGS. **9A** and **9B** are top and bottom perspective views of magnet assembly **170**. FIG. **9C** is an exploded view of magnet assembly **170**. Magnet assembly **170** includes magnets **171/172**, base **174** (which includes runners **176** and **177**), spring arm **175**, and spring arm head **178**. Base **174**, runners **176**, **177**, spring arm **175**, and spring arm head **178** operate in a way similar to angled portion **130**, runners **131**, **132**, spring arm **135**, and spring arm head **136**. The latter set of features are depicted in FIGS. **13A-13D** and described below. This disclosure applies to the corresponding features on magnet assembly **170** as well.

[0054] Magnet assembly **170** further includes magnet holder **173**, which has two apertures **181**, **182**. These apertures engage with corresponding features in base **174** to attach the magnet holder **173** with base **174**. Magnets **171/172** are coupled (e.g., glued) to magnet holder **173**. Drill bits and other metal components can be retained by magnets **171**, **172**.

[0055] Magnet assembly **170** is a type of accessory to tool holder **100**. Other types of accessories include shelf and bucket clips, bit and driver holders, battery holders, or flashlights. Any such accessory may include features described with respect to magnet assembly **170** or angled portion **130**. Such features include runners, spring arm, and spring arm head.

[0056] FIGS. **10A**, **10B**, **10C**, **10D**, **10E**, and **10F** are different views (front-side elevation, rear-side elevation, left-side elevation, right-side elevation, top plan, and bottom plan, respectively) of the first configuration of tool holder **100** shown in FIGS. **1A**, **1B**, and **1C**. FIG. **11** is a perspective view of a fourth configuration of tool holder **100**, in which mount **101** includes clip **110** and angled portion **130** and magnet holder **170**. In the fourth configuration, mount **101** is coupled to a lateral side of body **150**, and magnet assembly is coupled to the upper side of body **150**. FIG. **12** is a perspective view of a fifth configuration of tool holder **100**. The fifth configuration of tool holder **100** is identical to the fourth configuration except that mount **101** is coupled to the opposite lateral side of body **150**.

[0057] FIGS. **13A**, **13B**, **13C**, and **13D** shows a sequence illustrating how angled portion **130** connects and disconnects to/from body **150**. These figures are cross-sectional views of a portion of tool holder **100**. Not shown are rails **153**, **154** and stops **155**, **156** on body **150**. Also not shown are runners **131**, **132** on angled portion **130**, which engage with rails **153**, **154**. As described above, this system allows angled portion **130** to slide in and couple to different locations of body **150**. FIGS. **13A-13D** show more particularly how spring arm **135**, spring arm head **136**, and aperture **157** work together to allow angled portion to be removably coupled with body **150**. This depiction and description also applies to corresponding features of magnet assembly **170**, thereby allowing magnet assembly **170** to be removably coupled with body **150**.

[0058] In FIG. **13A**, angled portion **130** is pushed along body **150** towards plate **158**. Spring arm head **136** contacts tubular portion **159** of body **150**, thereby upwardly deflecting and compressing spring arm **135**. In FIG. **13B**, when spring arm head **136** reaches aperture **157** in body **150**, spring arm **135** decompresses and spring arm **136** drops into aperture **157**. In FIG. **13C**, a user places a finger into the underside of aperture **157**, thereby pushing spring arm **136** head upwardly and out of aperture **157**. As shown in FIG. **13D**, angled portion **130** can then be moved back, such that it can

be removed from body **150**.

[0059] FIG. **14A** is a perspective view of tool holder **100** with triggering-prevention portion **163**. FIG. **14B** is a rear-side elevation view of tool holder **100** with triggering-prevention portion **163**. FIG. **15** is an elevation view of tool holder **100** with triggering-prevention portion **163**, where tool holder **100** is shown holding a drill **10**. Triggering-prevention portion **163** has a U-shape, thereby forming an interior region. Triggering-prevention portion **163** includes receiving surface **164**. When a tool such as drill **10** is received by tool holder **100**, at least a portion of the tool rests against or abuts receiving surface **164** of triggering-prevention portion **163**. The portion of the tool that abuts receiving surface **164** (e.g., the handle of tool, as shown in FIG. **15**) is not a trigger of the tool. Instead the trigger will be positioned at least partially within interior region of triggering-prevention portion **163**. In such a way, inadvertent activation of a tool is prevented when the tool is received by tool holder **100**. Receiving surface **164** may include an overmold material that is softer and reduces undesirable effects of any impact or rubbing between triggering-prevention portion **163** and the tool. Triggering-prevention portion **163** is shown as integrated with body **150**, but may be one or more separable portions.

[0060] It will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes may be made and equivalents may be substituted without departing from the scope of the novel techniques disclosed in this application. In addition, many modifications may be made to adapt a particular situation or material to the teachings of the novel techniques without departing from its scope. Therefore, it is intended that the novel techniques not be limited to the particular techniques disclosed, but that they will include all techniques falling within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A tool holder for holding a tool, comprising: a body including an interior region configured to receive the tool, wherein the tool defines a primary axis; and a triggering-prevention portion coupled to the body, wherein the triggering-prevention portion is configured to prevent a trigger of a tool from being engaged when the tool is held by the tool holder.
